

MANIFEST: Part 5– May 17th

I. Welcome!

If you are a first-time guest or you want to plug in more to weekly virtual prayer meetings, our Wednesday night small groups, serving, or membership—*Fill out our digital Connect card to stay connected!*



II. Announcements:



PentecostATL 2026: We have the honor of hosting Pentecost ATL this year—bringing churches from across Atlanta together for a night of united worship and prayer, seeking a fresh move of the Holy Spirit in our city.
Sunday, MAY 24, 5-7 PM, at Atlanta International School

Join us for 10 days of upper room virtual prayer leading up to the gathering! Grab your Prayer Guide Today!

III. The Towel Before the Title, Hazen Stevens

FOUNDATION

“He gave some to be apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, shepherds and teachers; for the perfecting of the saints, to the work of serving, to the building up of the body of Christ...” — Ephesians 4:11–12 (WEB)

GIFT	PRIMARY CONCERN	STIRS IN YOU
Apostle	Pioneering new works and establishing divine order in the body.	To take new ground and play your part in the larger story God is writing.
Prophet	Hearing, seeing, and declaring the word and vision of the Lord.	To listen for God's voice and follow what He is saying.
Evangelist	The eternal salvation of souls through the proclamation of the gospel.	To share the gospel and live as a witness.
Shepherd	The spiritual health, care, and formation of disciples.	To care for the body and walk with one another over the long haul.
Teacher	Right handling of Scripture, sound doctrine, and practical obedience.	To go deep in the Word and obey what it says.

I. HEART POSTURE — SERVICE, NOT STATUS

Jesus knew He was Teacher and Lord. Out of that knowing — not in spite of it — He picked up the towel and washed His disciples' feet (John 13:3–15). The titles were real. The way He carried them was with a towel in His hand. **The greater the grace, the lower the posture.**

II. THE FIVE GIFTS

ALL OF US, IN DEGREES

- **Pioneers** must rise up alongside the apostolic. *We all are called to take new ground.*
- **Hearers** must follow the prophetic. *We all are called to hear God's voice.*
- **Witnesses** must follow the evangelist. *We all are called to share the gospel.*
- **Caregivers** must follow the shepherd. *We all are called to care for one another.*
- **Students of the Word** must follow the teacher. *We all are called to handle Scripture rightly.*

III. PRACTICAL APPLICATION

1. **Don't try to be like the gifted one.** Their expression is not necessarily your assignment.
2. **Receive their ministry through the Spirit's discernment.** Let it provoke your gift, not replace it.
3. **If you sense an inclination toward one of these gifts, nurture it.** Let it be tested, affirmed, and developed within a healthy community.

IV. FOR REFLECTION

- Which of the five gifts do you feel most drawn to — and why?
- Whose ministry has God been using to provoke something in yours?
- Where do you need to pick up the towel rather than reach for the title?

The towel before the title. Always.

NOTES:

SCAN
TO
JOIN
OUR
ZOOM
CALL



Join this week in Virtual Prayer! Join us as we press in to God together in prayer. Mornings (M-F) 7:30-8:15 am, Afternoons (M-F) 12:30-1:15 pm, Evenings (M, T, R) 8:30-9:15 pm